

Kay van den Aker

Designer and prototyper, exploring interactions that fuse digital and physical. Turning ambiguous ideas into experiences by gluing together various hard- and software.

Outside work, you can find him travelling, reading philosophy, or in the ocean doing various water sports. He's also been a surf instructor in Spain before.

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EXPERIENCE

Creative Technologist, Senior 2026 – now

Creative Technologist, Contractor 2024 – 2026

Google · Amsterdam, NL

Designing and prototyping concepts with SOTA gen AI to empower new creative workflows and educational experiences, at Google Research's Envisioning Studio.

Collaborating closely with teams like DeepMind, Labs and YouTube, and externally with filmmakers, designers, musicians and universities, from indies to world-class Hollywood directors. Co-creating and scaling positive futures by translating ambiguous and ambitious ideas, industry insights and Google's latest tech into new experiences.

Creative Technologist

Freelance · 2022 – 2025

Developed retail experiences for CHANEL & On (Modem Works).

Produced a CES showcase for ABB E-mobility (Above).

Created integrations, demos, and tutorials (Hapticlabs, ProtoPie).

Prototyped a bespoke digital interior concept (Rolls-Royce).

Researcher

Archetype AI · 2024 · Umeå, SE

Master thesis collaboration, explored physical AI as an interaction design material through a series of prototypes.

Design Technologist, Intern

Above · 2022 – 2023 · Malmö, SE

Developed concepts and prototypes for Google X & Mercedes-Benz.

Content Creator

Arduino · 2022 · Malmö, SE

Created uPython educational content, redesigned parts of Docs.

Creative Technologist, Intern

BMW Group · 2021 · Munich, DE

Created experience prototypes at the concept car department, mostly for the Vision i Circular, released at IAA Mobility 2021.

Co-Founder

Team RED · 2017 – 2019 · Eindhoven, NL

Co-founded and led design of a student startup building an interactive map to simulate the impact of sustainable innovations on an energy grid.

EDUCATION

MFA, Interaction Design

Umeå Institute of Design · 2021 – 2024

Class representative.

BSc (Hons), Industrial Design

Eindhoven University of Technology · 2016 – 2021

Honors Academy student council member.

Chairman of study association Lucid.

Exchange semester at Umeå Institute of Design.

Avalanche Boarders Surf Committee Treasurer.

TEACHING

Stanford d.school

San Francisco Bay Area, USA · 2025

Hosted a physical computing workshop at the Creative Computing Studio.

Copenhagen Institute of Interaction Design

Bergamo, IT · 2025

Ran a one-week course on designing and prototyping multimodal AI systems.

Amsterdam University of Applied Sciences

Amsterdam, NL · 2025

Project coach for IxD master students.

Technical University Munich

Remote · 2025

Hosted a Prototyping with AI workshop.

SKILLS

Interaction Design, Experience Prototyping, Programming, Web, Microcontrollers

HTML, CSS, JS, React, Next, Python, P5, Arduino, ProtoPie, Unity, Blender, SwiftUI, MadMapper, Laser-Cutting, Figma, 3D Printing, TouchDesigner